

Emily Ackwonu

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Cybersecurity and Compliance professional with over a decade of experience in risk assessment, vendor security, regulatory compliance, and cloud security across healthcare and government sectors. Demonstrated expertise in implementing and maintaining cybersecurity frameworks such as NIST 800 Series, ISO 27001, and FedRAMP, as well as conducting third-party risk assessments and managing governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) tools including Archer, ServiceNow, and Zen GRC. Proven track record in supporting Assessment & Authorization (A&A), vulnerability management, security control evaluations, and continuous monitoring efforts. Adept in cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP) and tools like Nessus, Qualys, Splunk, and QRadar. Holds industry certifications including CompTIA Security+, CISA, and CISM. Recognized for strengthening organizational security posture, fostering cross-functional collaboration, and ensuring compliance with HIPAA, PCI-DSS, SOX, GDPR, and other regulatory standards.

CYBER SECURITY TRAINING/SKILLS/STANDARDS/SOFTWARE

Advanced Analytics | Cyber Risk Assessment | Actuarial Methods | SQL | Python | R | Data Visualization (Tableau, Power BI) | NIST Guidelines Publications | AWS | Microsoft Azure | Google Cloud Platform (GCP) | SIEM (Splunk, QRadar) | GRC Tools (ServiceNow, One Trust) | Vulnerability Management (Nessus, Qualys) | Certification and Accreditation (C&A) | Assessment and Authorization (A&A) | HIPAA & PRIVACY ACT training | PCI DSS | ISO 27001 | IT Security Compliance | Vulnerability Assessment | Net| work Vulnerability Scanning | Information Assurance | System Risk Assessment | SOX Section 404 | CCPA | GDPR | PCI-DSS | HITRUST, FedRAMP | System Development Life Cycle | Nessus Vulnerability Scanner | ACAS | HBSS | SCAP | Splunk | SharePoint | Nexpose | LAN | WAN | ISO 31000 | ISO 27001 /2| NIST CSF | NIST 800 Series| COBIT | ITIL | NIST SP 800-53 | SP 800-53A | SP 800-37 | NIST SP 800-171 | FIPS | FISMA | FedRAMP | Risk Management Framework (RMF) | FIPS-199 | PTA | PIA | SSP | CP | SAR | POA&M | ATO | ISA | MOU/A | IDS | IPS | Windows | Archer | Linux | Microsoft Office | JIRA | Confluence & Kanban Board | SDLC | Waterfall/Agile Methodologies | Project Planning & Execution, SharePoint | Vendor Risk Assessments | Sanction Checks | Vendor Onboarding | Risk Mitigation.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- **CompTIA Security +**
- **Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA)**
- **Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)**

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Alexander Mann Solutions

Senior IT Governance Risk & Compliance

July 2024 to Present

- Developed and implemented enterprise-wide IT governance frameworks aligned with NIST CSF, ISO 27001, COBIT, and CIS Controls, enhancing organizational risk posture and regulatory alignment.
- Conducted comprehensive risk assessments and gap analyses across IT systems and business processes, identifying control deficiencies and recommending mitigation strategies.
- Led GRC program maturity assessments and successfully implemented process improvements, resulting in a 30%

increase in audit readiness and a 25% reduction in non-compliance incidents.

- Managed end-to-end internal and external IT audits (SOX, SOC 2, PCI-DSS, HIPAA), coordinating evidence collection, control testing, and remediation planning with cross-functional teams.
- Designed and maintained GRC documentation including Security Policies, Standards, Procedures, SSPs, SARs, POA&Ms, and Risk Registers to support compliance and operational excellence.
- Facilitated risk workshops with key stakeholders to evaluate enterprise risks using frameworks like NIST RMF, ISO 27005, FAIR, and OCTAVE.
- Built and maintained third-party/vendor risk management processes, including due diligence, risk scoring, and contract compliance reviews using GRC platforms like Archer and ServiceNow.
- Delivered strategic risk reporting and dashboards to executive leadership, translating complex IT risk into actionable business insights.
- Provided advisory support during security incidents, contributing to incident response planning, business continuity, and root cause analysis.
- Led the implementation of automated GRC solutions, streamlining compliance workflows and reducing manual effort by 40%.

People Scout

Information Security Analyst
2024

July 2019 – July

- Monitored, analyzed, and responded to security events and incidents using SIEM tools such as Splunk and IBM QRadar, reducing incident response time by 35%.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation efforts across infrastructure and applications using tools like Nessus, Qualys, and OpenVAS.
- Performed threat analysis and maintained up-to-date threat intelligence to support proactive security posture against evolving cyber threats.
- Supported security audits and compliance efforts (e.g., NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, PCI-DSS, HIPAA) by collecting evidence, completing assessments, and resolving control gaps.
- Administered security controls, including firewalls, IDS/IPS, antivirus, DLP, and endpoint protection systems, ensuring continuous protection across enterprise assets.
- Reviewed access controls and identity management policies, collaborating with IAM teams to enforce least privilege and zero trust principles.
- Created and maintained documentation for security processes, incident response plans, playbooks, and standard operating procedures.
- Participated in incident response lifecycle, including triage, investigation, containment, eradication, and recovery of cybersecurity events.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulations, leading to a 40% decrease in user-related security incidents.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to conduct business impact analysis, risk assessments, and implement mitigation strategies.

The Bacchus Group

Third-Party Risk analyst

July 2017 – June 2019

- Led end-to-end third-party risk assessments for over 100 vendors annually, ensuring compliance with NIST, ISO 27001, and SOC 2 frameworks.
- Developed and maintained a centralized third-party risk register, improving visibility and tracking of vendor risks by 60%.
- Conducted due diligence, security reviews, and contract risk evaluations, reducing onboarding time by 30%.
- Created and implemented third-party risk questionnaires aligned with business and regulatory requirements.
- Collaborated with legal, procurement, and security teams to identify, assess, and mitigate third-party risks across the supply chain.
- Monitored vendor performance and risk posture through periodic reviews, audits, and continuous monitoring tools.
- Automated TPRM workflows using tools like Archer and ServiceNow, enhancing process efficiency and audit readiness.
- Reported third-party risk metrics and risk findings to executive stakeholders, enabling informed decision-making.
- Ensured vendor compliance with data protection regulations (GDPR, HIPAA, CCPA) and contractual SLAs.
- Participated in incident response related to third-party breaches, driving post-incident remediation and vendor re-evaluation.

EDUCATION

- **MSC, Accounting & Financial Management** – The University of Maryland Global Campus
- **BA, Business Economics** - University of Saskatchewan